

Last Lecture Reflection

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After watching Randy Pausch's *Last Lecture* I felt very inspired, enlightened, and encouraged. I think the aspect that affected me the most was the idea that we as humans can have our whole life planned out, but things usually don't work out the way we planned them. I like his quote *"We cannot change the cards we are dealt, just how we play that hand"*. To me, this quote sort of sums up his lecture, highlighting how life can throw crazy and difficult things our way, but we must learn how to live with them, challenge ourselves, and overcome the brick wall. When Pausch would mention the brick wall, it changed the way I think about motivation. I sometimes find myself feeling very unmotivated and avoiding homework, tough conversations, or anything that makes me feel uncomfortable. I admired his quote *"Brick walls are there for a reason, they're not to keep us out. The brick walls are there to give us a chance to show how badly we want something"*. This quote made me rethink how I approach motivation and personal goals in my life. I want to get on the other side of these walls, and prove to my inner child that I can conquer any obstacles that come my way.

Another aspect of Pausch's lecture that resonated with me was his ideas about not only achieving our own childhood dreams, but also helping others achieve their own. I liked how he avoided making the lecture only about his own accomplishments, and leaned into how important it is to support other people around you and help them reach their goals too. He also kindly and thoroughly acknowledged his mentors and everyone that helped him throughout his career. This reminded me that sometimes I can get caught up in my own life, my own goals, and I neglect my loved ones and their goals. Pausch touched on the idea that it can be more fulfilling to help others than to just focus on yourself. Overall, this lecture was very heart warming and illuminating. Here is this man, given only months to live after a cancer diagnosis, gracefully boasting about his achievements while simultaneously thanking his peers and teaching us how we can support ourselves and the people around us. After noticing the lecture was over an hour long, I honestly was not really excited to listen to it, but I am so grateful that I did.